Supplementary Texts II

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Introduction
1. Correct understanding of “wild sex”
2. On sexual magic
3. Premature and delayed ejaculation
4. Correct understanding of the theory
5. Main wiles and corresponding solutions
6. Two possible paths
7. A type of woman who deserves trust
8. A war for a prize
9. Preemptive dismantling
10. Dealing with contradictory signals
11. Two frames of reference
12. Lovesickness
13. The blend of simultaneous opposite poles
14. Enemy love
15. On compliments and attraction
16. Some (in)definitions and (un)certainties to be established
17. War of minds
18. The cad’s devotion
19. Freeing the soul
20. Going further
Aphorisms
On translations and printings

Introduction

Let us continue the clarifications begun in the previous volume.

If you have not yet read the books, I suggest you do so to avoid distortions.

The content of these texts was not introduced here to be turned into dogma. They are only starting points for later reflection. Although some ideas are aimed specifically at those sympathetic to spiritualist studies, nothing prevents other people from learning about them.

I reiterate, once again, that I am mentally free and have no ideological commitments to anyone. I am the author of my books and may very well modify them and even renounce their content, partially or totally, if I so decide. It is not my fault if people do not want to think dialectically.

Never follow anyone; follow only yourselves. And even then, be careful!

Happy reflecting.

1. Correct understanding of “wild sex”

When I mention “wild sex,” I am referring to intense sex, in which the man applies his physical strength so as to “leave his mark” on the woman. This should in no way be confused with sexual depravity, for that is not what I referred to in the books. The kisses, embraces, touches, etc. should be intense and strong, so as to make the woman feel the man’s strength (what is popularly called a “firm grip”). However, the intensity of the act will depend on: the man’s age, his physical vigor, his state of health and his ability to keep himself short of the threshold of ejaculation.

Obviously, a frail man will have to practice sex gently, in accordance with his condition. A highly lustful man, who cannot bear the woman’s intense movements without ejaculating and who is incapable of prolonging the sexual act, will need to practice sex very gently and may even have to abstain from penetrating her at first. In this last case, he may limit himself to light caresses until he grows accustomed, at which point he may move on to more intense caresses. Men who cannot resist ejaculation at all and are incapable of maintaining chastity for long (and this is the case with almost all of them) can change their condition by initially abstaining from penetration while they grow accustomed to staying calm during sexual arousal. Mental and emotional excitement, when combined with sexual arousal, make ejaculatory restraint impossible. Whoever is incapable of staying calm before the naked woman or during her erotic caresses will never manage to penetrate her without ejaculating. Moreover, the more exaggerated the caresses, the more difficult the act is for the beginner.

The lustful man does not see the woman naturally, for he suffers from a sort of compulsive idolatry of sex and of the feminine. He is desperate with desire. Solving this problem requires the ability to feel the woman naturally, without artificiality. Calm blended with erotic arousal leads us to the point of balance.

Penetration should be careful, and the “thrusts” should correspond to one’s capacity for self-control, being regulated by the need to intensify or reduce sexual arousal.

What is intense for one person may not be so for another. Each one should regulate the intensity according to his condition. The intensity of sexual practice depends on people’s bodily condition.

2. On sexual magic

Once the wiles, little games and hells have been dismantled and a (always relative!) peace has been won in the relationship, it is time for us to enjoy the best that women have to offer us: sex. I am not referring to the inferior, depraving and harmful sexuality, but to a spiritualized erotic voluptuousness understood by few, which in occultism is called “sexual magic.”

Sexual magic is a way of “binding” the woman sexually to us, since few men are capable of performing it.

To be capable of practicing sexual magic, the male must be able to “take the pounding” from his partner. The ejaculatory impulse starts in the brain, and therefore only those who possess a high power of mental concentration are capable of stopping it.

The constant practice of sexual magic promotes the development of a sexuality opposite to the common one and wholly spiritualized. The average human being cannot live without orgasm because he has made it into a religion and has conditioned himself to consider it the main form of pleasure in existence. Our state of ignorance does not allow us to understand that the happiness of the Spirit is far greater than any earthly bodily pleasure.

To us, wretched worms of the mud of the earth, there seems to be no happiness greater than sensual enjoyments. The torpor of our consciousness does not allow us to understand that bodily sensoriality can lead us far beyond itself, toward the depths of the soul.

In the practice of sexual magic, it is important to win a steady partner and to keep well away from promiscuity.

There are other pleasures and functions in sex besides fornication and promiscuous depravity. I suggest that the reader research the subject immediately, with recognized and true masters. I am only a student of the subject, not a master, and I mention sexual magic solely for the reader’s information.

3. Premature and delayed ejaculation

Ejaculation is a reflex act resulting from mental overexcitement. On reaching an extreme degree of excitement, the brain sends the sexual organ the message that the moment to ejaculate has come. What leads the brain to send such an order are lustful mental images. If we suppress them from the mind, we also suppress the overexcitement. Hence, the key to keeping ourselves short of ejaculation is a mind clean of morbid thoughts.

When erotic fantasies excite the sexual organ to an extreme point, which is the point of ejaculation, the brain "understands" that the moment to ejaculate has come and sends the order. Thus, mental silence acts as if it "tricked" the brain.

During the sexual act, many memories, images and fantasies related to unsatisfied desires arise in the mind. The most secret erotic fantasies take hold of the mind and lead it into a state of growing excitement. When the excitement reaches a certain level, ejaculation follows. Those who suffer from premature ejaculation normally have a very excitable mind. However, by quieting the mind we can delay ejaculation and even suppress it. Suppressing ejaculation means suppressing orgasm, and not enjoying orgasm while trying to retain the semen (which is harmful to health). It is very important to distinguish the two things.

Suppressing orgasm means suppressing ALL erotic fantasies and lustful images from the mind, which includes: memories of beautiful women, plans to obtain a coveted female, images of women we would like to have but never managed to, specific kinds of caresses we enjoy, and anything related to all of this. The arousal of the sexual organ should originate only from the reality perceived by the physical senses (caresses and touches, contemplation of the woman's beauty, etc.), never from mental forms that are in our heads. The masturbator climaxes with mental images, and that is why masturbation is not recommended. Viewing pornography likewise strengthens this mental vice, conditioning the imagination. Ejaculation comes from morbid imagination. Ejaculation is avoided when the mind is kept quiet during the sexual act. If the slightest lustful thought enters the mind, an ejaculatory process is set off.

The fornicator is fascinated by the female figure and by pleasure, opens his mind to erotic mental images, identifies with them, savors them. He lives the illusion of his sexual fantasies as if it were reality. He places all his attention on the sexual organ, waiting for orgasm, while his mind, unguarded, is invaded by multiple mental forms[1] that dominate him and drag him along.

We have to invert the lustful psychological process of ejaculation. If we are seized by the desire to ejaculate and want to get out of the quagmire, the first thing to do is to focus our attention on the head and not on the sexual organ. The second thing is to stop the mind, that is, to interrupt the lustful processes of thought. The third measure is to stay calm, not to get carried away. Then we can begin observing ourselves, without identification, and consciously follow what we are doing: the conscious sexual act. Conscious observation of oneself is not possible if we keep thinking millions of silly things. The millions of thoughts we have are, for the most part, useless.

[1] The incubi and succubi described by Paracelsus. Such mental forms are autonomous, living psychic creatures, created by morbid imagination, and they grow stronger each time our thinking is drawn into lust. However, such mental creatures weaken rapidly when we learn to withdraw their food. If we do not dissolve them, on the other hand, they progressively distort thought and perception, slowly leading their progenitor, through ever greater depravity, to total ruin.

Seminal loss, whether it comes from fornication or from masturbation, can be avoided by staying vigilant and striking down lustful thoughts as soon as they begin to sprout. The same tactic serves to protect oneself against possession by any other defect. When we are negligent and allow thoughts to sprout and settle in, they soon grow stronger and it becomes almost impossible to remove them. Hence the importance of anticipating.

When erotic fantasies excite the sexual organ to an extreme point, which is the point of ejaculation, the brain "understands" that the moment to ejaculate has come and sends the order. Thus, mental silence acts as if it "tricked" the brain.

There are Hindu yogis who manage to avoid orgasm, retaining the semen, for years on end, and they achieve this through the power of concentration. True chastity is achieved when one is capable of having sexual relations for a long time with a single woman. It is not a matter of having one or another sexual encounter that lasts for hours, but of keeping far from orgasm for years and, preferably, even for one's whole life. Both premature ejaculation and delayed ejaculation should be avoided, replaced by virile non-ejaculatory penetration[2].

The ordinary person is not capable of living without orgasm. He has turned it into a necessity. Some even go so far as to consider an anti-orgasmic life an unhappiness, for they know nothing of spiritual pleasures. They are souls that enjoy only the illusory happiness of the senses and are enamored of matter. However, if we strive to transform ourselves, little by little we understand that there is something more beyond orgasm and that it is perfectly possible, and also preferable, to live without it.

I see no opposition between sex and chastity. In my view, chastity is incompatible with promiscuity and with orgasm, but not with the pure sexual act with a single woman.

[2] I am referring to a state in which the man keeps himself very far from the point of ejaculation, and not to some kind of orgasm in which the ejaculation is contained or "held back." Trying to stop ejaculation without renouncing orgasm is extremely harmful to health.

4. Correct understanding of the theory

The theory I defend in my books requires reading all the volumes to be correctly understood. The books are written in sequence, each one seeking to fill gaps and correct deficiencies in those that precede it. A partial reading will result in a deficient interpretation of their contents.

Since I value the continuous construction of knowledge, should there be an absolute (and not merely apparent) incompatibility of ideas between one work and another, the idea defended in the more recent work should prevail. I base myself on theoretical study and on experience, and neither of them is static.

Those who take what I write as finished ideas have simply understood nothing. I am totally opposed to dogmatisms. It never hurts to remember that I propose only a line of thought for reflection. I am no different from anyone else, and what I write could never replace the guidance of a true master (someone who has attained a state of turya, or awakened consciousness, as they say in India). That is why I do not like being called “master.” I am only a collaborator, a helper interested in these subjects who likes to share his point of view. I know that people need masters, I understand this need, but I cannot fill it. People feel the lack of a master keenly, and this is understandable. But they have already come many times and left their guidance. It is up to us to apply it. True masters were Buddha, Jesus, Muhammad and many others who came and who surely are still out there today. A master is a man inspired by God, so inspired that at times his soul merges with Him.

5. Main wiles and the corresponding solutions

Here follows a list of the most common wiles in women's little games and of the main means of guarding ourselves against them and dismantling them.

Wile	Solution
Sudden disappearance	Anticipation[3] Cornering[4]
Asking for the phone number and not calling	Anticipation Cornering Unexpected insistence[5]
Giving out the phone number and not answering	Anticipation Cornering
Infinite postponement	Anticipation Ultimatum[6] Unexpected insistence
Arousing desire and running away	Anticipation Cornering
Arousing desire and frustrating it	Anticipation Skepticism[7] Unmasking[8]
Arousing desire in order to accuse of harassment	Anticipation Unmasking
Feigned infatuation	Skepticism Cornering Unmasking
Dissimulation of real intentions	Skepticism Cornering Unmasking
Provoking jealousy	Unmasking
Provoking anger	Unmasking

[3] This strategy consists in informing the woman in advance that we are aware of the unpleasant facts to come, so as to show her that we already expect them and will not be caught by surprise. Communicating in advance empties the wile of its meaning, because it needs surprise to have its frustrating effect.

[4] It consists in creating a definitive situation in which even highly ambiguous conduct reveals the real intentions hidden behind dissimulated behavior. Example: "If you don't phone me within three days, you needn't ever call me again."

[5] This is an insistence in the direction of the negative pole of the problem, that is, the pole that is undesirable for us. They never expect us to push in this direction!

[6] It consists in setting a deadline for the person to adopt a clear attitude, after which we will take unilateral measures that resolve the problem. It is a form of cornering.

[7] It consists in not believing anything the person says or promises, considering everything a lie in advance, until proven otherwise.

[8] It consists in making explicit what one is seeing and what the person believes she is hiding. It should be friendly.

Hysterical fits	Silence Withdrawal Breakup
Minor betrayals	Enjoyment of what is possible Ending the commitment Breakup
Serious betrayals	Definitive breakup

Let us not consider the solutions above as ready-made recipes to be applied mechanically. They are only suggestions that require judgment and good sense when used. There is no total guarantee of effectiveness, for in the little games of the war of passion there is never a total guarantee of anything. We can only say that the chances of solving our problems increase when we begin to consider the solutions proposed here as possible means of dismantling the situations indicated.

For each problem there are multiple possible solutions. Obviously, I have not listed all the problems, nor all the existing solutions; I have only pointed out a few.

6. Two possible paths

In the work of winning the woman we long for, I see two basic paths:

1. A short and direct path;

2. An indirect and long path;

One path is positioned at one extreme and the other at the opposite extreme. Between the two, there are various possibilities and nuances.

On the first path, we make our real intention explicit; we create a clear and definitive situation immediately after meeting her. This route does not work with all women, nor does it suit all men. My view is that it only yields results if the woman is already interested beforehand, to a very high degree, in something we have, whatever the interest that motivates her. Here, tolerance of indefiniteness is zero from the start.

On the second path, we conceal the intention and at the same time progressively draw closer in intimacy through ever more compromising attitudes, until the moment we ask her out or something of the kind. I believe this route is the most workable for normal men and the one that has the most effect with so-called "difficult" women.

Many women take offense (*"What does he think I am?"*) when approached directly by normal men (*"Who does he think he is?"*). They become indignant and tend to rebuff them, even if deep inside they are gratified by the satisfaction of the desire for continuity. Only if the man makes a strong impression, through the right emotional impact, does the short and direct path yield positive results. When one lacks this ability, whether for economic, physical or other reasons, it is more reasonable to opt for the indirect route. It is longer and demands a great deal of patience. It is on the long path that we are most exposed to the unpleasant effects of the little games.

When we are not the object of intense prior interest, we are required to behave in a non-sexual way specifically toward the woman who interests us. This must be well understood: it is not a matter of general asexual behavior (toward all women) but of a stance of disinterest, or of little interest, only toward the woman who is blocking the approach. This means: acting in a highly masculine way but, at the same time, acting as if she did not interest us much, which is totally different from being a mere penis-less "bestie." Of course, if we proceed correctly, things will evolve to a point where concealment will no longer be possible, nor necessary: the moment of extreme intimacy.

If there is no pre-existing interest, the tendency is for us to be rebuffed, because the woman tries to keep us at a distance and does not allow us to reveal our attractions. If you are not the bearer of attributes that make an impact at first sight (height, a big car, fame, social prominence, etc.), you will need more or less close and prolonged contact to reveal your interesting side. Without entering the woman's field of consciousness, it is absolutely impossible to activate attraction. How could a person feel attraction for someone whose existence is not perceived?

But approach and contact will not be possible if the man lets his tongue hang out and stands there drooling like a wolf. The most one achieves with this behavior is to come up against a wall. Hence the need to conceal one's intention while revealing attractive masculinity and gradually drawing closer in intimacy. It is unnecessary to reveal our

specific interest, because women already tend to believe that they are desired. So why reveal something that is already known? To disconcert them, it is much more effective to generate doubts than to reinforce certainties (and isn't that what they do to us?).

I have seen that men, when they let themselves be seized by desire and grow desperate, tend to skip stages and rush through phases, which results in failure. This happens because they should have opted for the indirect path but could not bear it. They imagined themselves in the middle of the sexual act with the woman, were seized by desire and did not concentrate on the earlier stages.

Between the two paths described here, there are various nuances or shades, which can be chosen as real situations present themselves.

7. A type of woman who deserves trust

In the books I did not describe the virtuous woman much, and I will now try to fill this gap. I will seek to outline the female profile that is excluded from my criticisms and that was left out of most of my observations.

The trustworthy woman who deserves great consideration has the following characteristics:

1) She is sweet, affectionate and feminine;

2) She does not play little games;

3) She does not dissimulate;

4) She is sincere;

5) She does not lie; she tells the truth;

6) She does not cheat in love;

7) She does not act in a dubious (indefinite) way;

8) She does not try to manipulate situations to receive love without giving anything in return;

9) She does not pretend to love;

10) She commits no betrayals of any kind, whether minor or serious;

11) She does not flirt with other males while pretending to have eyes only for us;

12) She has no little male friends;

13) She does not condone or pity harassers (including the ones who put on a nice-guy face);

14) She is not forever going out with her girlfriends;

15) She does not give us false hopes;

16) She does not provoke our interest unless she really wants something with us;

17) She does not pretend to be interested only to run away afterward;

18) She does not attract in order to repel, nor in order to accuse of harassment;

19) She does not torment us with doubts;

20) She takes responsibility for the consequences of her acts and does not try to hide them;

21) She makes very clear what kind of person she is from the beginning of the relationship; 22) She does not pretend to be a saint when she chooses to have more than one partner;

23) She gives more importance to us than to other women;

24) She dresses decently or takes responsibility for the consequences of dressing in a way we do not like;

25) She does not repay love and devotion with coldness, contempt or rejection;

26) She does not repay companionship with horns or with sexual disinterest;

27) She never tries to sneak out of the relationship;

28) She does not suddenly disappear, out of nowhere;

29) She does not ask for our phone number if she does not really want to call;

30) She does not give out her phone number if she does not really want to answer;

31) She does not provoke our anger;

32) She does not kindle male desire with the intention of frustrating it;

33) She plays fair in love;

34) She does not try to bend us through infatuation;

35) She does not toy with our feelings;

36) She does not marry one man while loving another;

37) She likes us for what we are and not for what we have;

38) She does not want our money;

39) She values virtues;

40) She feels a strong sexual aversion to wicked men and cads;

41) She feels a strong sexual attraction to a kind man (sorry, but I can't help having a good laugh as I write this item!!!!);

This is the woman who does NOT disappoint us and who does NOT fit the profile that leaves us discontented and against which we rebel. A woman like this deserves all our love, fidelity and devotion.

Women who are decent and honest in love and in feelings, where are you? Show yourselves!

Jokes aside, there are no perfect women, just as there are no perfect men. But there are women who are a little better. The Feminine is indispensable to all of us (at least it is to

me, and I think to you too!). However, like everything in life, it is dual; it has two natures: a superior one and an inferior one. The inferior aspect is the one that torments us, and the superior aspect is the one that gives us relief. Because of this duplicity, it is not at all easy for us to deal with women.

8. A war for a prize

It is a common tendency, in the war of passion, for the feeling of triumph to belong to the one who got what he or she longed for from the start. It is not the only existing form of victory, but it is one of the possible forms.

In this case, the man longs to satisfy his impulse through the sexual act, and the woman longs to satisfy her desire to preserve male interest (the desire for continuity). The man will only feel satisfied if he completes the act, and the woman will only feel (temporarily!) satisfied as long as she receives constant demonstrations of interest from the man. After satisfaction, the man needs some time for his interest in the woman to be renewed. Therefore, we can say that male eroticism is discontinuous (it alternates in a cycle of interest and disinterest), while female eroticism is continuous, for the woman never stops wanting to be desired; her desire to be the object of the man's interest never cools. The author who drew my attention to this detail was Francesco Alberoni.

Going beyond Alberoni, however, I see an incompatibility between the male and female goals: they are mutually exclusive. It is from this incompatibility that the war of passion arises, made up of battles of love that good and sincere men usually lose.

It is not possible for both parties to come out victorious: if one wins, the other will lose. From the point of view from which I am now approaching this emotional conflict, the act of giving herself sexually is seen by the woman as a defeat, hence the countless compensatory demands. On the other hand, the same event is seen by the man as a victory, hence his sometimes insane insistence on getting the "final prize."

She will feel triumphant as long as she is able to resist him, as long as she does not give what he wants so much and is able to keep the flame of that desire burning. She will feel defeated if she satisfies him, because in that case the desire will end. But she will also feel defeated if she falls into the opposite extreme, acting so consistently that the man's feelings become resolved until every shadow of interest ends, through total giving up.

In the course of this war, both want to win; no one wants to lose. But the resources used are not, not by a long shot, necessarily honest. The weapons are the infernal and accursed little games. And women are the ones who master them best.

The suffering that comes from passion is the suffering of defeat. We suffer because we did not win, because we feel defeated, we feel we are on the losing end. When we come out victorious, the suffering is transferred to the other party. But there is a better way, not so vile, to escape this suffering: to defeat passion within ourselves.

The vagina is a kind of prize. If the man is victorious, the prize will be his. If the woman is victorious, the prize will stay with her. The war is to decide who will keep the trophy. The wise and experienced man does not fight desperately for the trophy. He knows that, if he does, he will be falling straight into the trap, diving headfirst into defeat. Instead, he dismantles the wiles and puts an end to the possibilities of conflict. The experienced man transcends the war of passion; he leaves it behind.

As long as we persist, insist and press, by whatever path, to satisfy our desire, we are granting victory to the woman, because we are giving her the chance to resist. We only rob her of the triumph when we ally ourselves with her resistance, pushing her in the same

direction in which she resists. Then we use her own strength to dismantle her wile, leading her, by her own efforts, to an unequivocal stance free of ambiguities. This is how we rob the female party of the triumph and dissolve the conflict.

What matters, in the battles of love, is to resolve our own feelings and not to force the other person to do what she does not want to. And feelings are resolved when doubts dissipate completely. You will not manage to wrest the necessary answers from her through disagreement, but only through agreement. The truths they stubbornly hide cannot be wrested out by opposition, but they can be brought to light when we agree with and ally ourselves to their stubborn resistance, carrying it even further than the sly ones had planned. Accept the resistance and carry it through to its ultimate consequences, and the truth will appear[9]. Then the doubts will end and the situation will be resolved.

I believe it is a serious mistake to resist in one direction while the woman resists in the opposite direction. This tug-of-war gives them victory.

Of course, the principle of non-resistance, which I have described in this chapter, must, like all the others, be correctly dosed and blended with opposite principles, as circumstances present themselves. There may be situations in which this principle is not the most advisable, or is even harmful. As a rule, it works well when the sly ones pretend not to want something (a date, for example) but, deep down, want us to insist and insist endlessly, to inflate their egos.

[9] She will not say explicitly what you want to find out and will not confess anything, but what was hidden behind the dissimulation will be revealed by her attitudes.

9. Preemptive dismantling

Let us imagine a hypothetical case. Suppose you happen to come across a woman who pleases you very much. She seems perfect to you, and you really liked her a lot!

So you ask for a phone number and she gives it to you with all kindness. Everything indicates that things are going very well: smiles, glances, wonderful conversations! Your hopes grow! You call her on the agreed day and then... she does not answer, leaves her phone switched off or something like that!

Or else suppose you manage to set up a date and she reciprocates completely. Full of feigned enthusiasm, she agrees to see you on such-and-such a date. But on the day of the date, she simply does not show up.

In both cases, you were the victim of a romantic swindle. Have things like this happened to you? Certainly they have, for such behavior is a rule and is predictable.

What were your mistakes? First: you believed her. Second: you got carried away with enthusiasm. Third: you did not create a definitive cornering situation that would force her to show her true face.

Breaking romantic commitments, kindly entered into, is a rule adopted by many women, and cornering situations are the conditions we create so that their true intentions are revealed. Since this is a dominant tendency, frustration is something predictable and expected, and it is much easier to anticipate it so as to prevent it than to remedy it.

Since swindling and frustration are the rules, whenever we set up a romantic engagement with a woman (a phone call, a date, an outing, etc.), it is indispensable to “pin her down” by means of cornering situations that define the situation before the sly one tries to frustrate us.

Since swindles are a rule, they should come as no surprise and, truth be told, they are merely something expected and predictable. Hence, the most sensible means of combating them is the prophylactic route: dismantling them before they begin. The most propitious moment to dismantle them is the one when everything is going wonderfully well (the moment when our hopes begin to grow). No enthusiasm! The moment she dangles a wonderful future (near or distant) before us is the moment to demand guarantees of sincerity, honesty, consistency and transparency. It is also the moment to communicate clear rules that prevent indefiniteness, sudden disappearance and other torments. It usually works to demand in advance that the commitments made be kept. What matters is to get out in front and arrive first, not letting the swindle happen, that is, aborting it before it is born.

10. Dealing with contradictory signals

When a man becomes interested in a woman and tries to approach her, he comes up against contradictory signals. Some signals are favorable to the approach, while others are unfavorable. Finding one's bearings amid this confusion of ambiguous signals is one of the great difficulties in the act of approaching. At the same time as the woman seems to be interested, she seems not to be. The contradictory signals blend into an infernal confusion, deliberately created, which allows the sly one to dodge advances on the grounds that she "is not interested" or that "you got it all wrong." In some cases, this ambiguity even allows the woman to accuse the man of harassment, despite her having sent him favorable signals. It is ambiguity that makes the false accusation of sexual harassment possible: the woman lures the man by means of favorable signals, as the fisherman lures the fish with the bait on the hook.

Because of these dangers, the man looks for certainties, but only very rarely finds them. Usually, certainties are only offered by very desperate women, whether because they are gold diggers, because they are excluded by men's selection criteria, or because they are being swallowed alive by the desire to be envied by their rivals. The male search for certainties is due to the real need not to expose oneself to the dangers of false accusation, of the traps of luring and fleeing, of luring and repelling, of extorting money through manipulation, etc. It is precisely for these reasons that certainty is denied and that we are offered the ambiguity of paradoxical behavior. And it is also for these reasons that we have to develop means of obtaining certainties, dismantling the wiles of double-meaning behavior.

So, whenever you are in the phase of approaching and making your move, keep this in mind: she will send you contradictory signals and behave in a double way, because she wants to have you in the palm of her pretty little hand. She wants to tame you like a dog, through desire, put a halter on you (or rather a collar, but it comes to the same thing) and lead you wherever she pleases. This game of double signals aims to preserve your desire and your doubt, preventing you from having certainties. She will play to the extreme and will not tire, because this game excites her. The more you play, the more she will like it, and she will be able to keep up the indefiniteness for years on end without the slightest disturbance. You can dismantle this wile by insisting on the unfavorable signals, and not on the favorable ones, pushing them to a point where the duplicity disappears, or else by applying an "ultimatum." You will not dismantle this wile if you insist on forcing her to intensify the favorable signals, because you will be giving her the opportunity to put up resistance and to feel desired and "pursued." However, it is advisable to take advantage of the favorable signals and "capture" them as they appear, not letting opportunities slip by, and going through the doors that are being opened, but always alert to any sudden betrayal.

Depending on the situation, one may sometimes rebuff the opportunities or, at other times, take advantage of them to advance a little further. There are cases in which one should even attack the favorable signals, resolutely rebuffing them when the woman shows herself interested, so as to strike her hard in her feelings. Such cases occur when the woman's bad intention is extremely evident.

11. Two frames of reference

Female desire takes its reference from the desire of rival females and from the degree of male (dis)interest (the desire for continuity). Let us analyze the first case and then the second.

The rivals are mainly those whom the woman considers more attractive than herself and who make her feel threatened in her power. If the rivals desire a specific man, our friend in question will also desire him (an unconscious projection of this behavioral trait is what led some feminist theorists to naively believe that we men also work this way). The engines of desire in this case are envy and competitiveness (which are among the fundamental weaknesses). This means that, if our companions believe that no other woman is interested in us, they will not be interested either (I am referring to sexual interest). She may keep us hooked, driven by ulterior motives, but she definitely will not feel sexually fulfilled. It also means that, if a specific woman who interests you is rejecting you, it is because she believes there are no better ones after you[10].

Female desire also takes its reference from the degree of male disinterest. The more interested a man shows himself in a specific woman, the less interest he will arouse in her. This means that, if you let it be understood that you merely "accept" her but do not desire her much, you will have greater chances of winning her or keeping her. But mind you: do not convey the idea that you are asexual, but rather that you are a demanding and highly selective male, who is only interested in the best and does not accept just anyone. In extreme cases, we can even carry out a "selective rejection," isolating a snobbish sly one while we reward other nice and friendly girls/women with our precious attention and care. Communicating specific disinterest leaves them indignant.

Combining the two frames of reference, we have the following logical result: the woman desires the man who does not desire her and who, at the same time, is desired by others who rival her in attractiveness. Therefore, for her to want you, she needs to believe that you do not desire her much and that other women want you. If we strike them with this tool, we break through their armor with the same efficiency with which our armor is broken by plunging necklines and short skirts.

A woman's interest usually runs dry from the moment the man gives himself up and lets himself fall in love. By handing over his heart, the man tells his goddess that her rivals are not up to standing against her in terms of seduction and attractiveness. When he says to her *"I love you! I love you! I love you!"* the wretched lovestruck man is saying *"You are incomparable, the best of all, the first on Earth!"*. If adoration is already established, what need will there be to cultivate love?

The desire for continuity is more intensely directed at men whom many attractive women desire than at those whom none wants. In these cases, the desire for continuity combines with the desire for victory in the competition and is reinforced. If the man is mysterious, both desires will combine with the desire to satisfy curiosity, becoming stronger still. If the woman wants to become invulnerable, she must overcome these weaknesses. If the man wants to break her resistance, on the other hand, he must strike her through these same weaknesses.

[10] It is interesting to observe that the feeling of rivalry seems to be rapidly activated when the rival is a friend of the rejecting woman. If a rejected man shows interest in the best friend of the woman who rejected him, he will kindle in the latter the feeling of rivalry with astonishing speed.

12. Lovesickness

When we suffer the pains of love, it is no use repressing the feeling or trying to smother it. Nor is it any use surrendering ourselves (as they hasten to advise us), letting the feeling dominate us. The ideal is to separate oneself from it in order to understand it through observation.

An important point is not to hide from oneself what one feels. Although it is not prudent to admit to others what we feel (still less to the beloved woman!), it is extremely important that we be sincere with ourselves. Not being sincere with oneself is tantamount to being stupid. I advise those who suffer to confess to God.

The pains of love that come from sudden abandonment or from other forms of betrayal can be relieved through deep and objective inner reflection. With the most absolute sincerity, without identifying, admit and confess, **to yourself**, what you really feel for the sly one. With deep attention and concentration of thought, ask yourself: What are the deepest feelings I have for her? What would I really like her to do? What do I miss most? What hurt me most? Which of her characteristics attract me most? Why do I suffer so much from the abandonment? These are only a few possible questions and serve only to get started...

The pain of love corresponds to an enamored and wounded “I.” It is a psychic aggregate that we need to disintegrate. The first and best way to dissolve an “I” is to get ahead of its invasion, dissolving all the subtle traces related to it: memories, thoughts, imaginings, acts, attachments to material objects, songs, etc.

The more conscious we become of the feelings we have, the freer of them we become. That is why Socrates and Jesus Christ said that knowledge of the truth is the key to the liberation of the soul. Indeed, suffering comes from ignorance. In the specific case of the pains of love, the suffering comes from countless illusions of which we are not conscious. I believe we should confess our feelings to our Inner God, asking Him for the liberation of our soul.

13. The blend of simultaneous opposite poles

The love relationship is marked by a duality of love and hatred. On one side are the displays of affection, caresses, flattery, smiles and tenderness. On the other are the provocations, the aggressions and the hostilities. Both poles blend in a simultaneity that would drive anyone up the wall... It is not exactly a matter of alternation, but of the fusion of poles. In alternation, the two follow each other in turn; here, both are expressed simultaneously, or nearly so.

The best word I can find to designate such a situation is "hell." In fact, the blending of opposite poles gives rise to situations of intense emotional stress, especially in whichever of the two people is more polarized and defined. And who usually has the more polarized and defined behavior? The man.

Anyone who polarizes himself on one side will suffer at a woman's hands, as will anyone who polarizes himself on the other. The violent man, who only knows how to react with hostility, has as much chance of destroying his love life as the tender and sweet man, who only knows how to give affection. The reason is this: their reactions are disproportionate and not suited to the real situations.

It is necessary to transcend this pair of opposites and to know how to react correctly, according to the circumstances. It is not advisable to let the woman drag us to the left or to the right. We have to keep ourselves centered and respond in kind to the contradictory behaviors, but without getting worked up as they do, and taking care not to invert the reactions that would be appropriate. Inappropriate reactions will always create problems. Positive behaviors (affection, tenderness, etc.) call for corresponding reactions on our part (not exaggerated ones, however), while negative behaviors (provocations, hostilities, hysterical fits and torments of every kind) call for firm and rigorous attitudes aimed at dismantling them. In the books, I devoted myself, out of necessity, exhaustively to the study of the unpleasant aspects of the feminine and of the love relationship, since there was a scarcity of material about this dark side. I found a great deal of material exalting female virtues and extolling romantic love, but very little dealing with amorous cruelty and man's suffering in love. I felt there was a need for balance, and this was the reason the dark side aroused my interest so much.

Put another way, we could say that the woman behaves toward us in pleasant and unpleasant ways, sometimes simultaneously and sometimes alternately. The pleasant behaviors form the positive pole and the unpleasant behaviors form the negative pole. Her behavior is neither polarized nor defined. Trying to fix them on one pole by force is a waste of time. Moreover, their pleasant and unpleasant aspects can present various degrees of intensity, ranging from light and faint to certain exaggeratedly intense extremes.

That is why we have to develop both capacities within ourselves. We need to be able to deal with both poles, alternately as well as simultaneously. This means having no expectations, being ready for anything and keeping ourselves continually on the alert to react on both sides (especially when the relationship is recent[11]). It is not easy to play against an "opponent" (ha ha) who attacks simultaneously from two opposite sides and who uses simultaneous opposite tactics. Therein lies a great difficulty. So we have to be

[11] With the passing of the years, however, we come to understand how our partner's psyche operates and become ever more capable of predicting her reactions. The unpredictability gradually fades as we observe her and strive to understand her realistically, without fantasies. Then we no longer deify her, nor demonize her.

always prepared for “attacks” that come from any side. The rule is “expect everything and be surprised by nothing.” According to philosophical pessimism, if we are prepared for the worst, we will not be caught by surprise. However, I think we should not expect only the worst, but also the best, all at the same time. In dealing with women, philosophical pessimism makes an important contribution (expecting the worst), but this contribution needs to be completed with its opposite pole.

Their positive side also needs to be energized and encouraged by us. Let us do so, however, with our guard up, since it is very common for the sly ones to strike us when we are off guard or, what is even worse, when we are offering them our love, an act that clearly constitutes ingratitude and even treachery.

14. Enemy love

As long as passion has not taken hold, it is very easy to repudiate it. At that stage, it is enough for us to stay vigilant against everything that may sprout within us as regards enchantment.

Very different is the situation of the man who makes the mistake of letting himself be carried away by enchantment/spell. When we make this mistake, we fall into an oscillating game of love and hatred that causes us immense suffering and does great harm to our health.

Emotional swindles are true frauds of love. They are traps for obtaining the other person's feelings without giving anything in return. They consist in kindling expectations and hopes only to frustrate them after the heart has been handed over. To swindle the other is to deceive him, inducing him to believe that he is loved when in reality he is not. In the romantic swindle, love and sincerity flow unilaterally and in one direction only, since one of the parties aims only to take advantage and exploit.

Women who cheat in love are very similar to any con artist and adopt the same *modus operandi*: they count on the victim's credulity and turn his sincerity into an instrument. They also operate like charlatan salesmen, who fascinate their customers and sell products that do not exist. They are walking frauds. The way is to guard ourselves with foresight and skepticism. We can say that the sexual and romantic market is controlled by them; they make the laws and dictate the rules.

The naive fall again and again for dishonest scams, until the day when, after many unpleasant experiences, they learn to guard against them before they happen. The experienced man does not fall for confidence tricks.

One feeling inevitably provoked by swindles is hatred. It is very difficult not to hate someone who plays with our feelings and uses our sincerity. This terrible feeling can become very intense and is usually proportional to the passionate love we felt before, that is, before we discovered that we had been double-crossed by the sly one. These are negative emotions provoked by the dirty games: anger, jealousy, the feeling of loss, of feeling defeated, double-crossed. It is no use at all trying to smother them: they explode and kill us. Nor is it any use surrendering to them: they will destroy everything around us, starting with our peace and our life. The only possible solution is understanding.

But it is not at all easy to understand reality when we are mad, and that is exactly what the accursed little games do to us: they make us irrational. The sly ones drag us onto the terrain of irrationality because that is precisely where they reign. It is on the terrain of the non-rational that the sly ones move with ease. On the terrain of mad emotions we have immense difficulty thinking and understanding[12]. In the whirlwind of chaotic emotions we become vulnerable, a fact that favors them. Then we are dragged in every direction. The emotional whirlwind clouds the mind.

As a man grows older, he must guard against the hatred resulting from his painful experiences with women. Otherwise, this hatred will devour him. He will need to transcend low and despicable, yet powerful, feelings.

[12] As Chris Rock says, the whole problem is that, for us, there is always a need for things to make sense.

Everything in nature develops in duality, and women are no different: they have a good side and a bad side. The good side enchants and the bad side bewitches. To let oneself be dragged along by the magnetism of one side or the other is to expose oneself to destruction by the opposite side.

In situations of defeat, it does not always seem advisable to me to seek out the woman to tell her everything that is stuck in one's throat (but sometimes it is!). Sometimes the best way to strike her is to say nothing, to isolate her forever, leaving her in perpetual doubt. It is not a matter of fighting hatred with hatred, but of taking precautions to protect oneself. And defending oneself is a just and legitimate right. A simple look, cold, penetrating and direct, can often communicate much more than hundreds of words.

In every war there are two sides, and the war of passion is no different. On our side are the sincere women, who do not deceive and do not resort to selfish wiles in order to be loved. On the other side are the insincere ones, who try to steal our love by dishonest means. Those who try to deceive us choose the enemy side and voluntarily place themselves in the line of fire. It is a war we would rather not fight, for it is not at all healthy, but one from which we are not allowed to flee. No man manages to escape this sentimental war; women do not allow anyone to flee, they give no chance at all. The only solution left to us is to sabotage, boycott, pull out the foundations. We dismantle the war when we stay out of reach, when we become inaccessible to understanding by the other side. The only means I know of achieving this is by attaining an inner state of total detachment, something only a few manage. Entering the oscillating game of love and hatred is the worst thing we can do. We should not hate the "enemy" but rather understand the state she is in. If we fight, it is only because we are forced to and not because we like it or because it gives us pleasure. There is no fun at all in living in hell.

In order to swindle, the sly one needs to know our feelings to find her bearings. When we detach ourselves completely, we are able to prevent our feelings from being probed.

15. On compliments and attraction

The vice of paying compliments is a terrible habit that drives women away instead of drawing them closer. It is a plague: all a woman has to do is look at us and send a faint favorable signal, and there we are, tossing out the wretched pickup lines. We flatter, we pay compliments, we court, we take risks and we humiliate ourselves in every possible way, almost always without any result. If, by chance, we get some positive result after such notorious conduct, it is much more likely to have been due to some factor other than the complimenting conduct.

The function of the compliment is to inflate the female ego. The uninformed believe that it has a sexually attractive effect, which is false.

Female sexual attraction does not result from compliments, but from the evidence of male sexual characteristics, chiefly conduct. The more masculine a man is, not only in physical appearance (because they are not as visual as we are) but also in conduct (that is, in his clothing, his speech, his gaze and his manners), the more attractive he will be. The same happens with women: the more feminine they are in everything, the more attractive they will be in our eyes.

It follows, then, that a man who wants to be attractive to a woman must curb the impulse to make advances and to harass, while at the same time highlighting his masculinity, bringing to the fore a virile, leading and protective conduct. A virile conduct is the conduct of a male. A leading conduct is the conduct of one who guides and commands. A protective conduct is the conduct of one who wards off dangers. When a man replaces harassing conduct with this synthetic, threefold conduct, women usually allow him to take care of them and gradually open up, since not doing so would go against their needs and interests. Female sexual attraction is pragmatic.

16. Some (in)definitions and (un)certainties to be established

In love there are certain things that must be made very clear and, if the woman is one of those who like to abuse our sincerity, others that must be kept very muddled. We men hardly ever understand this properly. Women seem to be born knowing it...

Abandonment may result from the certainty that it is impossible to hook us or from the certainty that they have already hooked us completely. In the first case, it is giving up out of fear of defeat. In the second, it is a triumphal withdrawal. The thing is that disinterest usually strikes them when they acquire the following certainty: *"He is firmly hooked on me; I don't need to worry anymore"*.

The woman attaches herself to the man and worries only as long as doubt is preserved. Doubt is preserved by indefinite male behavior.

Doubt about what is feared can cause more emotional suffering than the certainty of what is undesirable.

If our partner is difficult in love, we must correctly combine ambiguous behavior with definite attitudes. We do this in the following way: 1) offering indefiniteness (doubts) regarding what we feel; 2) offering definitions (certainties) regarding the attractions we have (protection, security, self-confidence, leadership, etc.) and also regarding the consequences of swindles and betrayals.

What provides certainty is clear behavior. What provides doubt is vague behavior that leaves "something in the air" and gives the feeling that there is "something hidden." Women are curious beings who cannot live without mystery. It is as if mystery gave them meaning. When the mystery ends, interest usually ceases to exist as well. Those who show themselves completely, moved by sincerity, do not reap good fruits in love. But neither can we be insincere, so as not to justify the insincerity of others. As a solution to this philosophical dilemma, I propose: that we be sincere up to the point where sincerity does not provoke disinterest and, beyond this point, not be insincere, but only mysterious.

17. War of minds

When a man irritates or enrages a woman, he is invading her mind through a door that almost always remains open. He will be the constant object of her thoughts, the target of her vengeful spite and of her hatred, but at the same time he may become the object of a gradual passion, since love and hatred, both being absurd, tend to follow one another and even to coexist. However, if this same woman dissolves the egos related to the negative feelings in question (irritation, hatred, feelings of inferiority, the need for revenge and many others), she will become armored and invulnerable.

Women usually armor themselves very well against enchantment (that is why letters, flowers and declarations of love do not work), but they seldom guard themselves against the bewitchment that takes place through negative emotions.

In the war of romantic conquest, what matters is to penetrate the other's mind, invade it and take root there. If they try to invade our mind, it seems legitimate to me that we turn their own spell back on them.

The woman will change her attitude if she is led to have opposite feelings. She will be led to opposite feelings if her beliefs undergo an inversion. And her beliefs will undergo an inversion if we work our way in and reach her mind with the right attitudes. It is not a matter of manipulating, persuading or convincing: it is a matter of making her aware of what we are capable of by means of right, impactful attitudes that destroy her mistaken beliefs about us. By destroying the beliefs, we also destroy the resistance.

In the war of passion, the one who constantly thinks about the other party is the defeated one.

Women, if you don't want us to come in through the back doors, close them!

18. The cad’s devotion

I have observed that cads are not negligent toward the relationship. They are highly devoted, but they are so only to achieve their selfish goals.

The cad lies, deceives, cheats. He promises the moon and the stars in order to defraud the women who trust in him. He is a great braggart. Through his feigned conduct, stuffed with lies, he manages to impress women intensely, striking them unerringly in their feelings and leading them into an exaltation of the imagination.

The cad excites the female imagination and, by extension, the feelings.

It is not correct to say that the cad is not devoted. He is devoted, and very much so. He is just devoted in a selfish way. The cad is the exact male version of the tramp.

The cad dangles the possibility of turning into a faithful man. He dangles this possibility but does not make it real, exciting, but not satisfying, the female desire for continuity.

Women seem to me highly vulnerable to cads because they are impressionable. Cads tend to be braggarts and theatrical in order to impress. They lie a lot; they say exactly what women want to hear. They are forever boasting and singing their own praises! They normally extort a good deal of money from their lovers.

The cad’s various lovers suffer over him, because of their unsatisfied desires for continuity and domination. The cad, however, does not suffer over any of them. His devotion consists in adopting the best means of deceiving them. When the cad falls in love, he is struck down by his own spell.

I believe that women should work on their weaknesses so as not to be so vulnerable. They should learn to value virtues and stop rewarding wicked men, for this vice does them no good whatsoever.

19. Freeing the soul

Changing destiny

It is the right of every man[13] to transform himself into someone different from what he has always been. Every man has the right to modify himself and thus to change his life. We have the right to think today in a way totally different from, and even contrary to, the way we thought yesterday. We have the right to adopt new conceptions, new ideologies, new stances, new attitudes, new conduct and new behaviors. To remain petrified in the past, static, is not to evolve. Whoever perfects himself necessarily changes; he transforms himself into another. That is why we have to adopt a continuous construction of our conceptions.

Throughout our existence, we suffer a great deal emotionally. Our existential suffering has as its fundamental origin, in my view, the imprisonment of the soul in animal impulses. Such impulses are distortions of pure natural instincts that become deformed by the abstract mind when we reach the humanoid state. If they once served to guide the soul and protect the physical body and the species, now they enslave it and drag it like leaves in the wind, toward destruction. The suffering that originates from unsatisfied desire, from the swindles and selfish wiles of the person we love, from romantic passion, from betrayal, from hatred, etc. has its origin in animal impulses. We are animals in the process of humanization, which is why we have to transcend the impulses. Allowing blind impulses to guide us is to throw oneself headfirst over the precipice. We should not “smother” the impulses; we should transcend them.

Life is a network of paths, with many branches. Desires draw us along these roads and build our destiny. Every attitude has multiple consequences that unfold over time. What we are today results from choices made in the past. Since desire disregards free will, our destiny is woven unconsciously to a great extent.

When we fall into a given situation, we do so as a result of having set off in that direction earlier. Had we set off in other directions, we would now be in other situations (the butterfly effect).

It is always advisable to pay attention to the possible future consequences of our great and small acts, in order to avoid whatever might harm us or others. In this way we avoid acquiring karmic debts.

If one person fights with another, this is because both set off down this path in the recent or distant past. Had they in no way entered the road of conflict in the past, they would not be in conflict now; the conflict would not be possible.

We can avoid disagreements with our partner, with family members or friends by getting ahead of them and avoiding them. Before a conflict sets in, there are many signs that betray the fact that we are heading down that path. It seems better to me to prevent than to remedy, although we also need to know the means of remedying.

[13] In this chapter, I am using the word “man” generically, also including woman under this term. I would like to point out that the use of this generic expression often harms the male sex instead of benefiting it. Consider, for example, the cases in which it is said that “man destroys nature,” “man is a wolf to man,” “cursed is the man who trusts in man,” etc. In all these cases the generic expression is used to the detriment of the male side.

To change the course of our life, we have to begin by avoiding mistakes before they arise and by turning away from destructive paths. This applies to great and small things. If I cannot refrain from a glass of alcohol when I am in a bar, then I should not go into the bar. And if I cannot avoid going into a bar when I meet a friend, then I should not meet this friend, at least until the day I am cured of this vice and can then influence him to go with me to other, better places.

Any destructive act or situation can be analyzed in search of its origins. A man may drink because he meets a friend, and he may meet a friend whenever he goes to a certain place. But he may go to that place whenever he wants something specific, which apparently has nothing to do with the friend or with the vice. The chain of events that follow one another in time in a causal relationship has no definite limit.

The death of details offers us the opportunity to divert completely the existential course programmed by the egos according to the law of recurrence, launching us onto a path whose direction, from then on, will be consciously determined to a great extent.

Small acts, apparently harmless, can have serious undesirable consequences. Hence the importance of keeping watch over ourselves.

The manifestation of a small detail opens the way for the manifestation of other defects, ever greater and more serious. It is much easier to avoid the first slip than to get out of the mud once we are stuck up to our necks. But if we are already stuck in the mud, and this is the case with most of us, we have to avoid sinking still deeper and also avoid treading this path at the next opportunity, which arises every day.

Those who tread this path to “total sinking in the mud” every day reinforce the path and make it wider and wider. But they also have, every day, the opportunity not to start treading it, and therein lies the key to their salvation. They must discover the before of the before, where the point lies at which they began to tread it, get ahead of it a little more still and stay there. At that starting point of the wrongful act lies an important detail to be watched.

A sequence of acts that, one after another, bring us closer and closer to a catastrophe has its beginning in something apparently harmless. There lies the starting point on which we must work.

To free ourselves from the clutches of a destructive behavior, we have to know its causes. On the three-dimensional level of the physical world, such causes are rooted in the acts, thoughts and situations that preceded the behavior in time and that should have been avoided. Had they been avoided, we would not have arrived at the present situation.

What matters is to begin a new life. And one cannot begin a new life while preserving the elements that gave rise to the old, undesirable life. To begin a new life, we have to change whatever is giving rise to the problems in our present life. In some cases, it is worth moving house, forming closer friendships with people different from those we associated with in giving rise to the problems, doing new things and ceasing to do the old things that have always resulted, through an often long chain of events, in catastrophic situations for us or for our fellow human beings.

In the case of love, I believe we should not become involved with a person who makes our life worse. We should become involved with someone who allows us to make her life better, or else look for another person for a romantic relationship. And if the desire to become involved with complicated people is very strong, we have to discover where the causes of this desire lie (the why before the why that came before the why...). We have to go back as far as we are able.

Not feeding the defects

It is fundamental to cut off the food of the defects we aim to dissolve. The food is cut off by avoiding the situations that favor them. It is contradictory to allow oneself to fall into situations favorable to the desires while aiming to eliminate them. The pretext of throwing oneself into such situations in order to observe the Ego is a trap the Ego sets in order to survive, for it is a mistaken use of the psychological gymnasium. Throwing oneself into the gymnasium to "enjoy" the flavor of events, instead of discovering these fascinating enjoyments so as to separate ourselves from them, leads us to an even greater enslavement to the "I's."

Therefore, the same psychological gymnasium that serves for the discovery and liberation of the soul can serve for its imprisonment if it is taken the wrong way.

A person addicted to pornographic films will not manage to free himself from them if he goes on watching them on the pretext of "studying lust." In truth, he will not be studying anything, because he will be identified. A drug addict will not manage to free himself from the addiction if he goes on meeting his addict friends on the pretext of "studying his own addiction." What should they do? Discover the psychic elements that start these self-destructive processes, eliminate them and completely change the course of their paths. The pornography addict should no longer go near newsstands or movie theaters; the drug addict should move to another city and make friends with other people. Thus, by avoiding the causes, we free ourselves from the consequences.

It is of no use at all to fight against the defects, observe the thoughts, etc. if we are strengthening them at every moment through unsuspected channels.

In short, we cut off the food of the defects and bring about their withering when we grow accustomed to reacting immediately to their faint approach, not allowing them to settle in. Their approach in any center is quickly detected by one who is in a state of alertness.

Moments to take advantage of

There are moments when the passions and desires cool down and leave us in peace, temporarily. These are moments when we should work intensely on these psychic elements to weaken them, driving from the mind all related thoughts and keeping away from situations that usually lead us to rock bottom. Before the undesirable moments return, that is, before the desires and passions we are fighting against trouble us again, we have to tread other paths that lead us in different directions and avoid the same addictive paths along which we always end up stuck up to our necks.

The moments of cooling usually follow the satisfaction of desires (which does not mean that we should give ourselves over to satisfaction in order to bring them about).

These are moments when it really comes to seem that we will no longer be tormented by the undesirable impulses again and that we are definitively satisfied, forever. However, the error of such an idea is not long in revealing itself: after a lapse of time, short or long, dissatisfaction returns and desire presses once more for satisfaction. Here there is an important point to be considered.

It so happens that the return of desire does not take place abruptly. Before we are shaken again by the impulse itself, small reminiscences arise, small memories, thoughts or acts that mark the beginning of the manifestation that will soon be repeated. Such subtle, almost imperceptible reminiscences are not difficult to disintegrate, since they have not yet gathered strength. If we stay vigilant against them long before they appear, getting ahead of the manifestation, we can detect them at the exact moment they begin to sprout and react immediately. How should we react? By breaking the identification and praying for the disintegration of that impulse, which is still subtle at this level of manifestation[14]. The fact that the manifestation is still weak makes dissolution immensely easier, which is why it is supremely important not to allow it to grow strong and grow, which happens quickly after a few seconds of negligence. All it takes is for us to let a single wrongful thought settle in, and soon we will be unable to rid ourselves of its baleful results.

By the path described above, we can free our soul from dangerous sexual desires, from violent romantic passions, from destructive jealousy, from wrath, from tragic hatred and from all the negative and harmful impulses that make us or our neighbor sick. Without freeing the soul from animal impulses, it is not possible to transcend the hells of the love relationship, nor other related psychological hells. Whoever does not emancipate his soul remains bound to inner sufferings, among them suffering in love.

The mind is a problem

The mind is the great enemy of the human being. We suffer because we think. The passions grow strong and dominate us because we think. Thinking, remembering and imagining are ways of strengthening desire. Desire has the mind as its foundation. If we do not remember, we do not desire. We desire because we think. That is why the quietness of the mind is our continual and principal concern.

But there are insistent thoughts that come back, and back, and back, bringing their desires with them. My explanation for this is the following: such thoughts are the secondary product of hidden primary thoughts. In other words: thoughts that we do not see or to which we give no importance (because they seem harmless) open the way for other thoughts, whose harmful character bothers and worries us. Before a thought insists, it is preceded by other precursor thoughts. Innocent thoughts make room in our mind for worse thoughts. Hence the importance of keeping watch.

The liberation of the soul lies in forgetting.

By watching the mind, we get ahead of bad thoughts and, consequently, of the desires they bring.

[14] I strongly recommend that the reader go deeper into this subject in the Gnostic literature.

The harm done by desires

We have seen, on television and in the newspapers, how desires lead people to disgrace. And the more we occupy ourselves with these same desires, the more we reinforce them. The more we struggle, the worse. The more we give in, equally the worse. The solution lies in a third path, which is that of the death of the Ego (observation without identification, accompanied by understanding and prayer).

It is a mistake to try to contain or repress our own attitudes while at the same time reinforcing them with thoughts and memories. To dissolve passion, we have to discover in ourselves everything related to it and separate ourselves from all of it.

A cause of failure

One of the reasons why we fail to overcome our defects is the interruption of vigilance and/or of devotion.

There are moments when we are absorbed by the worldly concerns of everyday life and forget our complete dedication to the Spirit. These are moments when we are distracted by commitments that seem very important to us but that, when all is said and done, are of no use at all.

The moments of negligence are also called the “spiritual night.” The I’s subtly grow stronger in such dark phases and suddenly burst out with full force, always dragging us a little further toward rock bottom. In the moments of night, we have the impression that everything is fine and that we do not need to attend to vigilance and prayer. Then the baleful results are not long in coming.

The solution to such a problem consists in never allowing vigilance and prayer to cool, taking special care in the moments when we feel safe.

20. Going further

As time goes by, experience accumulates. The accumulation of experience transforms one's conceptions. My conceptions of today differ from those of yesterday and will differ from those I will have tomorrow.

In my books I detailed the dark side of the feminine. Today I think that perhaps I exaggerated a little, since some readers seem to have gone blind to the other side. However, there is also a sublime side to the feminine that we cannot ignore.

The state that is superior to the emotional hells is not a polarized state, whether against or in favor. Let us understand that polarization will always bring bad consequences. If we are blind to either side, we will be under a partial, conditioned and stubborn view that will be very harmful to us.

The fact is that both sexes need each other. Woman cannot live without man, contrary to what people usually say out there. And man, as everyone knows, cannot live without woman. So, no trying to become "self-sufficient"! We have to learn to dismantle wiles and dishonesty with the sole aim of legitimate self-defense, and not in order to polarize ourselves against the opposite sex. We have to learn to dismantle the war of passion and refuse to fight in this war.

Today I think that we should in no way enter into a "tug-of-war." More than ever, I believe that we have to transcend and overcome the wiles and swindles, not reinforce them further with attitudes that justify them. Repaying dishonesty with dishonesty is reinforcing the game and feeding the endless cycle of swindles in love, precisely what we must destroy.

We have to break the chain, break the cycle. We only manage this through an inner state superior to the situations. To vibrate on the same wavelength is to chain oneself to the endless circle of suffering.

Love also presents itself in a dual form: it can wound and kill, but it can relieve and heal. Let us distinguish conscious love (altruistic) from emotional love (wrongly considered true love).

We should remember that, although there is a dark side to the feminine, there is also a dark side to the masculine, and that both reinforce each other in an infernal dance. I do not advocate that we reinforce our dark side as a way of fighting the other party's dark side. Opposition dams up the contrary forces. We need to be superior to evil and not equal to the opposite side.

Even while aware that human beings (including women, obviously) are selfish and tend to be users, we have to refrain from harming them. We have to learn to protect ourselves without causing them harm or, at most, causing them the least harm possible. If she provokes your hatred, do not hate. If she tries to deceive, manipulate, betray you, etc., sabotage, boycott, dismantle, but do not return the same thing, because, as I see it, you will be wounding yourself. Return something superior.

Today I think I ought to rewrite a good part of the books, for a more exact understanding. Perhaps I failed to reinforce certain points that are missed today. When I sometimes recommend, for example, returning women's wiles, I am referring to a mirror effect (bouncing off and coming back) and not to revenge. It is not a matter of repaying,

out of mere vengeful desire, some wiles with other, different and additional wiles; it is only a matter of isolating the sly one in her own trap, so that she plays alone and experiences what had been intended for us. “Returning the wile” is creating a refractory barrier that carries the wiles and their undesirable effects back to whoever launched them; that is, it is refusing the unpleasant “gift” that was offered to us, as the legend of the Buddha tells.

It bothers me a great deal to see that there are people who get it all wrong and suppose that I endorse romantic revenge. What I endorse is the boycott of dishonesty in love and also certain just retaliations. If at some point I wrote something that allowed another interpretation, it was out of mere conceptual inexactness. I sympathize with the just indignation (and even with the anger) of whoever is swindled, but I do not believe that the best thing for our health is to fixate on these feelings. It is understandable that we feel anger, but it is not healthy to cultivate it.

True happiness does not lie in the other person; we have to seek it in ourselves. We have no reason to demand that women “make us happy,” for this is not within their reach. If they are not capable of making even themselves happy... much less could they make us so!

Once the correct inner state has been attained, we will be fully aware of the condition in which present-day women find themselves but, at the same time, we will accept that state as something that is theirs by right of free will (just as our emotional defense is also a legitimate and inalienable right). We will not nurture resentments or negative emotions of any kind, for we will understand that we all have our own defects. Whoever does not have them in one field has them in another, since there is no one who is a little saint.

If she does not understand the value of true love and scorns the sincerity you devoted to her, so be it! Remember that people are the children of their own deeds. If she made you very angry unjustly, remember that she did so because she was deluded by the lie that swindling others is an advantage, but that the days of that joy will also come to an end, since in the end we will all be equal. There is no sly one who can swindle time...

Aphorisms

Acts of will

The will is confirmed by acts and not by mere thoughts or intentions. We will not manage to change our behaviors, thoughts and feelings simply by making efforts upon ourselves without confirming them with attitudes that correspond to the new patterns. Making right efforts is important, but cooperating with those efforts by acting in accordance with a new behavior is indispensable.

The more we repeat a new behavior, the more it becomes consolidated in our nature.

Changing one's behavior is something gradual. It demands patience and persistence. No one becomes the opposite of what they are from one moment to the next.

Solidarity

We must show solidarity with the weak, not scorn them, and understand that each one is at their own level. What is easy to achieve for one may be extremely difficult for another.

Easing irritation

When a person irritates us, we can ease the irritation by keeping alive in our consciousness the remembrance that there is in them another part, different from the one now manifesting. In this way, we place ourselves above the situation, we protect ourselves, and we may even help them. This is a good way to avoid fights with one's partner.

Let us see beyond the person who acts in a way we do not like, seeking their true Being. Every person has a higher part that can manifest through them in various degrees.

Boiling point

The soul that attains the deep understanding that it is the slave of a desire that harms it may reach the point of weeping.

Women who swim against the current

The world is lost, and human wickedness seems to have no end anymore. Nevertheless, there are still people of both sexes with goodness within them. There are women who do not abandon their men and stay with them to the end, even in sickness. However, they are not many, for a simple reason: in people of both sexes, selfishness prevails. Even so, we must love humanity and help it, for, deep down, the human being does not understand what he does. The human being is ignorant and does not see that, by harming his neighbor, he is harming himself.

It seems to me that female wickedness is exercised more in the sphere of sentimental selfishness, whereas male wickedness is exercised and refined in other fields and has, for that reason, a broader spectrum. The women who set themselves apart are at odds with the common tendency. These exceptional women who swim against the current are as rare as the men who deserve them.

True love

Loving pleasant people is easy. What is hard is loving unpleasant, petty, lying, treacherous, cheating people, etc. Therein lies the merit. However, this does not mean that we should be fools enough to let wicked people do whatever they want with us.

Relief for the soul

The feminine is a consolation for our pain and suffering, without which our life becomes unbearable. A woman's affectionate embrace brings relief to the soul. Knowing this, some ill-intentioned sly ones take advantage of this weakness to take us for a ride.

Only the divine androgyne (which begins at the angelic state and goes beyond it) can live without the opposite sexual complement, for he has developed it within himself. He is beyond man.

Fascination

We consider women so beautiful and adorable because the astral light saturates our nervous system, creating a highly fascinating and irresistible illusion. We do not see them in reality; we see only their illusory beauty. It is this beauty that reaches our mind.

Eliminating lust

We have to dissolve the lustful passions for our own benefit, and not to satisfy moral conventions or the orders of religious leaders.

Self-extinction

The growing perversion seen in humanity unequivocally shows that it has entered a cycle of self-extermination.

Systems of difficulties and of solutions

The difficulties they create for us are problem situations.

The set of all the difficulties created by woman forms a system. The set of all the solutions we can make use of to resolve such situations forms another system.

To the system of difficulties they create, we must oppose our system of solutions.

Each difficulty or problem may have multiple possible and effective solutions, whose applicability will vary according to the contexts (hence the impossibility of dogmatic minds understanding me).

Motivating feelings

Feelings that do NOT motivate me to write: hatred, anger, revenge and resentment.

Feelings that motivate me to write: indignation, discontent and rebelliousness.

The ignorant cannot tell the two groups apart.

Shortest path

The quickest way to dismantle the little games is to crush them before they arise or as soon as they have begun.

Synonyms

Ambiguity = little game = torment

Malleability

My philosophy does not adopt fixed procedures. It is therefore of no use to human robots.

Too much coldness fosters a woman's loss of interest, just as too much affection does.

The man who is always a tough guy has as many chances of losing his woman as the man who is always a pushover.

Character of the theory

My theories are philosophical-spiritualist in nature and not political. I do not believe in politics. For me, politics is the result of the inner state of the populations.

Nymphomaniacs

Even nymphomaniacs run away from desperate harassers, which proves that they too have a selective criterion and that they do not like sex for sex's sake, but seek it for other reasons. The motives for their promiscuous conduct are not genital-sexual.

Animality still

The attractive male profile still belongs to the level of animal attraction, from which we need to free ourselves.

Snowball

The conquest of a highly desirable, beautiful and voluptuous woman influences a man's psyche, making him confident. That is why the more beautiful women one has, the more women one will attract, and the more of a cad one is, the more partners one will have. However, the destructive effects of this conduct are not long in coming. Those who do not believe it, let them wait and see!

Pleasurable resistance

Female pleasure lies in resisting. The more you press, the more she resists.

A useless strategy

Trying to argue with a woman who is resisting the desire she herself kindled is to increase her resistance even further. I see many men trying to convince resistant women to go out with them. They present arguments, contest, debate and try to win the discussion.

They want, through logic (!!!!!!!!!), to lead them to reason that the sex they are offering is a good deal. Of course, they will hardly get anywhere. They should insist, in measured doses, in the opposite direction so as to open up their defenses. One cannot convince sentimental beings by the rational route, with arguments and discussions.

Pushing in her favor

Never press, or, if you do, do it in measured doses in the direction she does not expect: in favor of her stubborn resistance and not against it. Go along with her tendency and adapt.

Lack of interest toward stingy women

Do not try to steal what she refuses (sex). Show a lack of interest in what she considers so valuable. Make her understand that there are billions of vaginas on Earth.

Reversing

She comes close to provoke you and run away. If you take the bait and go all out after her, she will run away, because what interests her is the game of pursuit and resistance. If you run away suddenly, abruptly, she will give up, perhaps because she considers you not much of a man.

Want to disconcert her? Behave ambiguously, almost running away or running away slightly, while at the same time moving closer. Run away on one side (in a certain sense) but move closer on another. Receive her approaches while seeking a slight distance. Then you will force her to intensify the provocations to a point of no return.

Feigned infatuation

Feigning infatuation and devotion is an efficient way of inducing innocent people to give away their hearts. Believing in the other's sincerity, such people feel safe to surrender. It is sentimental selfishness in action. This wile is fought with skepticism or, in more serious cases, with the same weapon.

The terrible weapon

A dangerous weapon, used in the war of passion, consists in feigning passionate submission to the other person, letting them believe they are in total control of the situation, until the point where they become snobbish, and then suddenly pulling the rug out from under them by switching to the opposite behavioral extreme. Only then will they realize that they had fallen in love without noticing it! This is a dangerous weapon in the hands of ill-intentioned people, and I describe it here only so that good people can defend themselves.

Activating the feelings

To the signs of masculinity present in behavior, let us add, in conquest, the ability to activate a woman's feelings, through empathy and enchantment. He who uses it with ill intent will be a cad. He who does so with sincerity and altruism will be a great man.

Criticizing out of wanting

No one would rebel against female wiles, nor waste time devising ways to dismantle them, if he did not like what women have that is best. No one would fight the dark side if he did not want to unite with the luminous side.

The only ones who become discontented with women are those who would like to receive from them what is best in them and that is denied to them.

A misogynist, by the very definition of the word, is someone who feels aversion toward women. Therefore, as a simple matter of logic, a misogynist could never be a heterosexual man. The mere fact of being a misogynist would make a man a non-heterosexual person.

The principle of continuity

It never hurts to repeat: one of the basic principles that govern them is that of maintaining the continuity of male interest. They want us to surrender, but they do not want to surrender themselves. They want us to give over our hearts, our feelings, our souls and our sex, but they do not want to do the same. They seek a one-sided surrender on our part. They want us to give them what they refuse us. They resist surrender as best they can, kindle our hopes and try to keep them alive at all costs. Some even go so far as to think that we are obliged to praise them, exalt them and adore them, becoming furious with the rebels who do not.

It is out of the desire for continuity that they dress and act provocatively. It is also because of this principle that they have developed very elaborate forms of dissimulation, which allow them to feed our hopes and provoke our desires in total safety, without any responsibility being imputable to them.

The sly one wants you to give over your heart, your feelings, your sex and your soul, while she refuses to do the same, for she seeks one-sided surrender and domination.

Leading the man to surrender completely, while keeping for herself alone the sobriety of refusal, is the continuist logic that governs this type of woman. She does not accept the male refusal to surrender but, on the other hand, considers that she has every right to do it, for this right is understood as an exclusively female privilege.

Mistaken paradigm

The female sex is neither incomprehensible nor unpredictable, as everyone says and believes. It is we who try to understand it from the wrong perspectives. Common sense starts from false and mistaken assumptions (paradigms) in its attempts to observe and analyze it, which is why the idea occurs to us that women are creatures that are hard to understand.

Why not to surrender

There are two important reasons why it is not advisable to give away one’s heart: 1) They tend to flirt with other males as soon as we turn our backs; 2) They become cold and distant as soon as they realize that we are in their hands.

False advertising

They offer us the best they have, to buy our hearts. When we give them what they want so much, we receive torments in place of what had been offered to us.

Male and female adultery

Male adultery does not wound women so much because they do not like us very much and, for this same reason, they forgive us more easily. On the other hand, female adultery wounds us excessively, because we like them desperately. The pain of betrayal is proportional to the feelings one has. Since love and hatred are two sides of the same coin, the hatred unleashed by female betrayal is proportional to the previous love (that is, immense), and for this reason we cannot forgive them in such cases. Besides this, there is another aggravating factor: we know that they could easily resist male advances if they wanted to.

Because they like so much, men become more resentful of betrayal, unlike women.

Radical machismo and extremist machismo

Being radical is different from being extremist. The extremist is dogmatic, and the radical is solidly grounded and rooted (radicalis/radice = root).

A danger

A danger that constantly lurks around us is that of women who marry one man while remaining in love with another. The deceived husband believes himself loved but feels that something is missing; he perceives that there is something strange but cannot define what it is. In general, he feels guilty for what seems to be wrong. This suffering accompanies him for as long as the relationship lasts. Be careful.

An absurd theory

The ignorant suppose that, because they are constantly trying to provoke male desire, women constantly desire sex, being repressed by “bad men.” According to this absurd hypothesis, we would be afraid of female sexuality and would be constantly engaged in stifling it, preventing it from manifesting. Therefore, according to these laypeople, our goal would be to create a world in which women were sexually cold and constantly avoided sex. We would have a preference for those who were frigid and, that being so, we would not complain about sexually “dull” partners(!). Quite the contrary: they would correspond to our erotic fantasies. Needless to say, the facts confirm exactly the opposite.

Heavy fire

The knowledge I produce is heavy fire against insincerity and abuses in love. That is why it is detested by dishonest people.

Proof by experience

Let us review our lives. Those who loved us most are those who did not have the certainty of being loved back. Those who abandoned us were those who had that certainty.

The irritation of doubt

When we observe them, we see that there are several things in their behavior that "do not fit" and that we cannot understand. That is why we cannot rest in tranquility (read Peirce).

Error in trying to understand

The various kinds of desire that women feel for men give rise to confusion when they describe the ideal man. It is always important to ask: "What does she want a man like this or like that for? For what purpose?" Only in this way can we understand the dynamics of female desire.

Failing to differentiate the multiple kinds of female desire leads people to attribute a sexual meaning to desires that do not have one.

The error of most analysts consists in not contextualizing female desire in the terrain of practical functionalities. They commit it by starting from mistaken paradigms to study women. I believe that the use of accounts and questionnaires is a serious error for anyone who wants to understand women. The best thing is to observe them in action and also to take men's accounts into consideration, something few scholars do. Moreover, it seems to me that analysts neglect direct, lived experience with this disconcerting gender.

Such are the reasons why so much nonsense is said and written about these beings who interest us so much.

Defining it one way or the other

What matters is to achieve emotional well-being, inner peace. This will only come if the situation is defined, if everything is very clear. If the sly one does not want to define things on the pleasant side, then let us define the situation ourselves on the unpleasant side. In matters of love, the certainty of the unpleasant is preferable to the torment of doubt. If she says she loves you but behaves to the contrary, then let her take on this undesirable behavior as the rule. And let her know that we are aware that her true feelings correspond to those attitudes and not to what is said merely from the lips outward.

Additional swindles

Here are some female swindles that I have not detailed much: not cooking, not going out with us or not having sex (or doing all this grudgingly) but never admitting it, so that we keep waiting like fools. The intention is to create and maintain expectations in order to frustrate them constantly or in homeopathic doses.

Aberration

Modern marriage is an aberration, since it has become a trap to prevent man from having sex (both with his wife and with other women) and to keep him from having satisfaction. It is a pity, and it should not be so.

The solution, in my view, is not to fight marriage, but to strive for it to be different. A promiscuous single life hastens discarnation.

On translations and printings

As for printing the books to read, feel free. Reading on computer screens is not good for the eyes.

As for translation, I do not mind if parts (chapters or passages) are translated, provided that responsibility for possible errors of language and of interpretation of the literal and metaphorical meanings of words and sentences is not attributed to me.

These two permissions do not apply to the old and obsolete versions of the books, only to the current versions.

Glossary

This glossary was added to the English edition and is not part of the Portuguese original. It lists the author's key concepts that appear in this book, with the original Portuguese term and the English rendering used throughout the translation.

alternation (*alternância*) — The deliberate oscillation between coldness and affection, attributed by the author to feminine emotional games and recommended to men, following Lévi, as a way of crossing and alternating one's action.

bewitchment (*enfeitiçamento*) — Extreme fascination of consciousness; the author treats it as a psychological, not supernatural, phenomenon.

conscious love (*amor consciente*) — Following Samael Aun Weor, the higher form of love, as opposed to sexual and emotional (romantic) love: a disinterested wish for the beloved's well-being, free of possessiveness and of the need for closeness. The author considers it the true love.

cornering (*encurralamento*) — The author's strategy of placing someone before a choice that exposes their real intentions.

death of the egos (*morte dos egos*) — The inner work of dissolving the egos; for the author, the source of freedom from manipulation and of resistance to all passions.

ego, egos (*ego, egos*) — In the Gnostic sense used by the author (after Gurdjieff and Samael Aun Weor), the many psychological defects that make up the ordinary personality, not a single unified self.

enchantment (*encantamento*) — Fascination produced through pleasure and desire (flattery, seduction, promises).

female (vs. Woman) (*fêmea (vs. Mulher)*) — The author contrasts the authentic, capitalized Woman with the instinctive "humanoid female animal."

humanoid (*humanóide*) — The author's term for the ordinary human being: a rational animal driven by instinct and by the ego, which merely has a human appearance and has not yet become an Authentic Man.

I's (*eus*) — Gurdjieff's "many I's": the multiple, contradictory selves that take turns controlling a person.

passions (*paixões*) — In the classical philosophical sense: desires, fears, and attachments that sweep the will along, not only romantic love.

psychic aggregates (*agregados psíquicos*) — Samael Aun Weor's term for the egos understood as autonomous psychological formations within the psyche.

psychological gymnasium (*ginásio psicológico*) — A Gnostic term for everyday life and its situations as the field in which one observes and dissolves one's defects. The author warns that seeking out tempting situations on the pretext of observing the Ego is a misuse of it that only strengthens the "I's."

sentimental selfishness (*egoísmo sentimental*) — The author's name for the principle that, in the war of passion, only one's own feelings matter. It drives the sly ones to judge as "logical" whatever gives them desirable feelings and to seek constant proof that the man is suffering for love.

sexual magic (*magia sexual*) — The occult term the author uses for a spiritualized, non-ejaculatory sexual practice with a single steady partner, opposed to promiscuity and to the common pursuit of orgasm. He presents it as requiring great mental concentration and refers the reader to recognized masters for its study.

spell, sorcery (*feitiço, feitiçaria*) — Used psychologically: an extreme form of fascination that works through the victim's belief and fear.

ultimatum (*ultimatum*) — In the author's strategy, a final demand that forces a definite decision.